Indira Sawhney V. Union of India AIR 1993 SC 477

- Also known as Mandal Commission Case.
- On January, 1979 under the Chairmanship of B.P.Mandal, the second Backward Classes Commission under Article 340 was appointed by the Union Government headed by Prime Minister Morarji Desai.
- One of the major recommendation made by the commission was that, besides the SCs and STs, for other backward classes which constitute nearly 52% of the population, 27% government jobs are be reserved so that total reservation for all, SC,ST and OBCs, amount to 50%.
- No action was taken on the basis of the Mandal Report for long after it was submitted, except that it was discussed in the Houses of Parliament twice, once in 1982and again in 1983.
- On August 13, 1990, the V.P.Singh Government at the Centre issued an office memorandum accepting the Mandal Commission recommendation and announcing 27% reservation for the socially and educationally backward classes in vacancies in civil posts and services under the Government of India.

Glossary



Fraternity - Universal brotherhood which is stipulated in the Indian constitution

Exploitation – Misusage of resources

Egalitarian society - Society without stratification

Privileges - Special schemes or rights for particular human communities

Injustice - Activities which are against the will of people

Social identity - An indicator which locates the people in a society

Apartheid - Suppression of one race by the other

Varna system - Divisive phenomenon in the society

Minorities - people who belongs to a group at less number in population

Reservation - Policy which helps people for upliftment

Plural society - Varied on the basis of culture

Social change - Change which creates behavioral variation

Civil rights - Rights provided by the government to live in a society

Political rights - Rights of the people in the political sector

Economic equality - Less cleavage between people in terms of economic condition

Dharma - Do's and Don'ts

Landlordism - Exploitation by land owners

Deprived - Economically and socially exploited and exhausted

Panchamer - people who are out of the Varna system

Justice - Fair distribution of authoritative allocation of values

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